

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a newspaper article about the happiest citizens in the world:

Happy in Switzerland!

Switzerland is home to one of the world's most successful economies and also one of the happiest populations in the world. In fact, Switzerland was ranked the world's 3rd happiest country in the United Nations' 2013 World Happiness Report, while Hong Kong was ranked 64th (out of 156 countries).



So what's Switzerland's secret? The tiny European country – with a small population and very few natural resources – is known for investing in its people. Switzerland invests more in the health, education and talent of its people than any other country in the world. This has led to an economy that is competitive, highly innovative and an educated society that has adopted technology quickly. Below are four things we can learn from Switzerland.

1. **Excellent healthcare.** With a high-quality healthcare system that provides universal coverage, the Swiss live longer, are emotionally and physically healthy, and thus feel better.
2. **High-quality education.** 86% of adults aged 25-64 in Switzerland have earned a high school diploma, and the Swiss also have higher average test scores in literacy, math and science.
3. **Talent and innovation.** Switzerland is number one in the world for innovation, on-the-job staff training, attracting talent from elsewhere and government-funded training. The Swiss are well-paid and retain their own talent.
4. **Well-developed infrastructure.** The Swiss have created an efficient transportation system and excellent Internet connectivity.

As members of your school's Model United Nations club, your group has to give a talk about Switzerland and Hong Kong. Discuss with your group what to include in the talk. You may want to discuss:

- how Hong Kong compares with Switzerland in the four points mentioned
- whether Hong Kong's ranking should be higher
- how Hong Kong can improve its happiness ranking
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. What makes you happy?
2. What makes you unhappy?
3. Are you happier than your friends?
4. Do you think young people in Hong Kong are happier than their parents?
5. Why are some people unhappy even though they have good health?
6. Does having poor Internet connection make you unhappy?
7. Is there a relationship between education and happiness?
8. Can where you live affect your happiness?

DO NOT TAKE AWAY